

Getting past Modal's CTO to the capacity team

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

\$750M round in progress at \$15.75B (Sep 28)	2 leads in Wave C	9-12 mo Ops and Engineering hiring highs (Sep 26)	0 network owners found
STAGE Wave C prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Modal Labs (Wave C), 2 leads	LAST TOUCH Sep 29: call to CTO Akshat Bubna	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: find the compute capacity / infrastructure owner

Bottom line

Modal is a serverless GPU platform that raised \$355M in May and is **closing a \$750M round at \$15.75B** (Sep 28). Operations hiring is at a 12-month high. Modal mostly rents GPUs from clouds and neoclouds rather than building data centers, so its fiber needs are indirect. Your sequence went to the CTO and one security engineer; neither replied. The plan is to find who manages compute capacity, ask one question, and decide whether Modal is a buyer or a pointer to the neoclouds it rents from.

What Modal is, in one analogy

Modal is like a ride-hailing app for GPUs: it doesn't own most of the cars, it rents them and dispatches work. The car owners, the neoclouds, buy the roads. Modal tells you which owners matter.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
\$750M round at \$15.75B valuation in progress (Sep 28); \$355M Series C (May 21)	ZoomInfo news	Money to secure more capacity.
Operations roles at a 12-month high; Engineering at a 9-month high (Sep 26)	ZoomInfo scoops	Scaling the team that buys capacity.
London office opening (Aug 6)	ZoomInfo news	Growth outside the US. Chicago is not obviously on the map.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 11-28	Wave C, 3 emails	To CTO Akshat Bubna	No replies
Sep 16	Wave C	Some steps skipped as 'already bounced'	Check deliverability
Sep 28-29	New lead + call	Brandon Crisp (Infrastructure Security) added; call to Bubna	No notes

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Capacity / infrastructure lead (to identify)	Search ZoomInfo for compute capacity, infrastructure, supply	n/a	The real buyer of capacity.	Unknown
Akshat Bubna	CTO and co-founder (HubSpot)	Boston (617)	Founder; won't read cold vendor email.	3 emails + call
Brandon Crisp	Infrastructure Security Engineer (HubSpot)	Oregon (541)	Can name the infra owner.	Email 1 Sep 29

Not worth chasing for this goal

Founders and security staff are not fiber buyers.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Brandon Crisp Infrastructure Security Engineer

Why them: Can name the owner.

Channel: Email Tue Oct 6 | Subject: Quick pointer?

Brandon, who at Modal decides where your GPU capacity lives and how it's connected? I own fiber in Chicago and would rather ask the right person once than spam a team. A name is enough.

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Mon Oct 5	ZoomInfo search for Modal capacity/infrastructure leaders.	-
Tue Oct 6	Email Brandon Crisp.	-
Week of Oct 12	Email the capacity lead with one question: any Chicago capacity planned?	-
Oct 30	Qualify in or out.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 30	Know whether Modal has Chicago capacity needs	HubSpot note

Guardrails

- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company; 1 Apollo search.

Sources

Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Modal Labs (Wave C)'; HubSpot notes; ZoomInfo news (Feb 11, May 21, Aug 6, Sep 23, Sep 28, 2026) and scoops (Sep 26).